NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

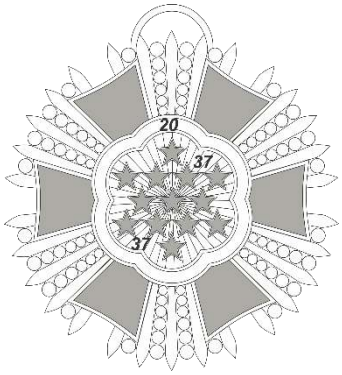
MIL-DTL-3943/394B(IH)
2 October 2026
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-3943/394A(IH)
30 November 2021

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

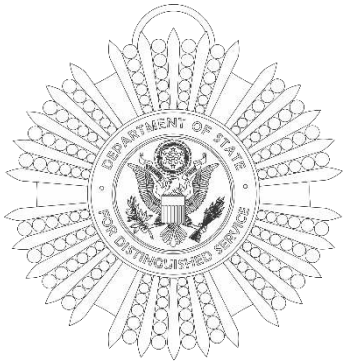
DECORATION, SECRETARY'S DISTINGUISHED SERVICE AWARD, DEPARTMENT OF STATE

This specification is approved for use by all
Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense

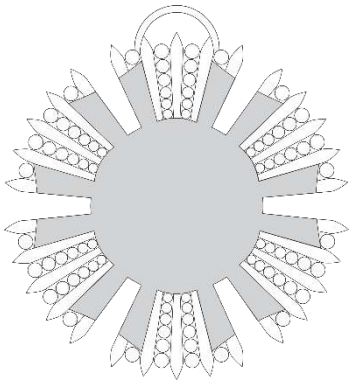
The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the latest issue of MIL-DTL-3943.



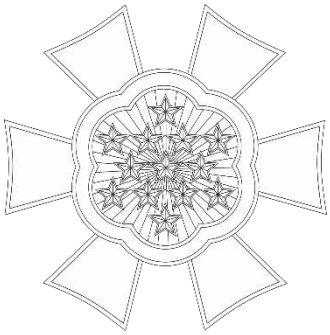
OBVERSE



REVERSE



BASE/PAD



DEVICE

DASH NO.
-1: Regular Size
-2: Miniature Size

AMSC N/A

FSC 8455

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T02:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MATERIAL (-1 and -2): Red Brass 85/15 (UNS Alloy No. C230)

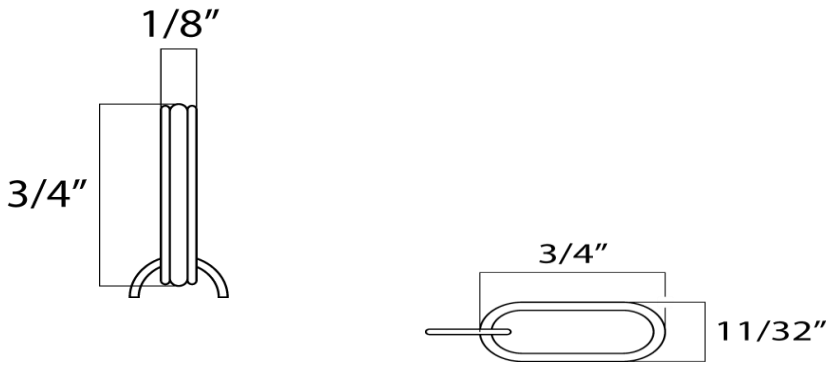
FINISH:
BASE:
OBVERSE: Nickel Plated, Matte Finish, Polished Highlights and shall match The Institute of Heraldry (TIOH) Metal Finish Chip Number 18.
REVERSE: Will have two-tone plating, The six Outer rays will be Nickel Plated, Matte Finish, Polished Highlights, shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 18, The center circle with the seal shall be 24K Gold Plated, Matte Finish, Polished Highlights and match TIOH Metal Chip Number 8.
DEVICE (Obverse and Reverse): Epoxy resin, 24K Gold Plated, Mirror-like Polished and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 6.

DIMENSIONS:
BASE:
HEIGHT (Including lug):
-1: 2-5/16 inches (REF)
-2: 1-3/32 inches (REF)
DEVICE (Diameter):
-1: 1-3/4 inches (REF)
-2: 27/32 inch (REF)
WIDTH (Base):
-1: 2-1/8 inches (REF)
-2: 1 inch (REF)
THICKNESS:
BASE: (At edge)
-1: 0.151 ± 0.010 inch
-2: 0.114 ± 0.010 inch
DEVICE (Across middle)
-1: 0.127 ± 0.010 inch
-2: 0.092 ± 0.005 inch
ASSEMBLED:
-1: 0.255 ± 0.010 inch
-2: 0.178 ± 0.010 inch

DECORATION SET: The decoration set shall consist of a regular size pendant with neckband, miniature size medal with ribbon drape, service ribbon, ribbon attachment and lapel button all packaged in a decoration case conforming to MIL-DTL-14633, Type XV, Style 3, with a Class 1 pad. The following text shall be inscribed on the top of the presentation case using 3 lines: (Line 1) THE SECRETARY'S (Line 2) DISTINGUISHED SERVICE (Line 3) AWARD. Lettering shall be accomplished using Bodoni MT Bold type face, 24-point caps for the first letter in each word and 20 point caps for all other letters. The words "UNITED STATES OF AMERICA" shall be accomplished using upper case, Copper Plate, 10 Point Gothic.

SUSPENSION RING: The suspension ring through which the neck ribbon passes shall be made from Gilding Metal 95/5 (UNS Alloy No. C-210) or Red Brass (UNS alloy C-230) and shall be plated with a Nickel Plated, Mirror-like Polished Highlights matching TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number18. The suspension ring shall conform to the dimensions specified below and be hard soldered to the pendant.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T02:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



EPOXY: Epoxy resin shall be applied to the Decoration as indicated above and shall match TIOH Hard Epoxy Color Chip Numbers listed below.

TIOH HARD EPOXY COLOR CHIP NUMBER	LOCATION
Blue #20	Outline of Cloud
Yellow #37	Background Inside Cloud
White #28	6 Arcs and Stars (Shaded)

NOTES:

1. The term (REF) refers to the measurements taken from the Government furnished hub or die.

2. The specification slash sheet for the ribbon for the neckband, pendant drape and service ribbon is MIL-DTL-11589/682

3. The specification slash sheet for the lapel button is MIL-DTL-11484/396.

4. The specification slash sheet for the ribbon attachment is MIL-DTL- 41819/61.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodian:
Army - IH

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activity:
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8455-2026-613)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T02:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.